

MIXOLOGY

**TREND**

At Ambar Ubud Bar at Mandapa Reserve, Bali, their Spirits of the Jungle cocktail festival began not behind the bar, but deep inside a forest. Visiting mixologists from across Asia weren't handed menus or spirits. They were handed baskets. Led into a nearby forest, they foraged for wild herbs, berries, and roots, returning with boxes of ingredients they barely knew hours earlier. By evening, those same ingredients had found their way into drinks that tasted like Ubud and narrated a story of Bali. It felt less like a bar takeover and more like a culinary expedition. And that's what's the biggest bar trend.

For years, terms local, seasonal, and farm-to-table belonged almost exclusively to kitchens. Restaurants built entire identities around proximity to produce, relationships with farmers, and the freshness of ingredients. Bars, in contrast, leaned on global supply chains. They flaunted spirits, syrups, and citrus flown in from exotic corners. That divide is now dissolving. Across the world, cocktails are entering their own era of consciousness.

Sustainable cocktails are about linking the drink to its origin, the land and the people behind it